

Website SEO Roadmap

IELTS AI Tutor by IELTSGRADER - maximize organic SEO fastest

Canonical: <https://www.ieltsgrader.com> | Living doc: SEO/WEBSITE_SEO_ROADMAP.md

North star

Organic search -> helpful article -> sample + examiner analysis -> try-it CTA -> /ielts-essay-checker -> free band score -> practice -> subscription. Do NOT chase head terms 'IELTS' / 'IELTS Writing'. Own Writing + AI evaluation.

Speed levers

- Long-tail exact-match first (Q&A posts index/rank fastest)
- Velocity: 2-3 new URLs/week + 2 improves/week (1/week loses this market)
- Snippet engineering: 40-55 word answer under H1 for Position #0
- Data moat: publish studies from real graded essays competitors cannot copy
- Same-day indexing: sitemap + GSC request + IndexNow + homepage/hub link

Competitive reality

- Legacy blogs (Liz, Advantage, Simon): static advice -> we add live AI eval + fresh samples
- Official orgs (IELTS.org, IDP, BC): generic -> we own emotional long-tail (stuck at 6.5)
- Direct AI checkers (Writing9 etc.): same promise -> out-teach with examiner analysis + data studies
- AI content farms: thin listicles -> real scored essays + side-by-side band tests

SERP recon (mandatory before every post)

Search the exact query. Record: (a) format that ranks, (b) PAA questions, (c) word-count of top 3. Match format, beat depth, capture PAA. Log in frontmatter.

Part A - Diagnosis (priority filter)

Critical risks (close first)

- GSC www not verified; sitemap not submitted; P0 not requested
- Prod prerender not guaranteed on every deploy
- www vs apex inconsistency
- No weekly GSC -> title rewrite loop

Lead-review risks (also close)

- Scaled-content / HCU: every post must pass B4 quality bar; no template-only text
- E-E-A-T: author bylines, methodology page, last-updated dates
- SERP recon before writing; rotate internal anchors; no Wave C template cloning
- Track time-to-index (<7 days) and competitor positions monthly

Full 28-item risk register: see WEBSITE_SEO_ROADMAP.md Part A2.

Part B - Flywheel + quality bar

URL roles

- Attract: blog guides / Q&A / topics
- Prove: scored samples, band comparisons, error taxonomy
- Convert: /ielts-essay-checker (primary), Task 1/2 checkers
- Orient / Deepen / Monetize: AI tutor, mock, band-score, pricing

Page recipe (every Attract/Prove page)

- Exact keyword in title, first ~100 words, one H2
- Examiner-style teaching + Try-it-yourself block
- CTA -> essay checker; related blog link; FAQ schema on Q&A

B4 length by type

- Q&A / snippet: 800-1,200w | answer in first 40-55 words under H1
- Guide / how-to: 1,500-2,200w | steps + before/after + checklist
- Scored sample / topic: 1,200-1,800w | full essay + TR/CC/LR/GRA justification
- Comparison / trust: 1,500-2,500w | side-by-side real scores
- Pillar / hub: 2,000-3,000w | TOC + section per subtype

Title / E-E-A-T

- Title <=60 chars, keyword front, one honest CTR modifier
- Meta 150-160 chars: keyword + benefit + soft CTA
- Author byline + methodology page + last-updated + Article dateModified
- Rotate anchors: check with AI / band score free / try checker / see how it scores

Part C - Improve existing URLs

Improve before creating near-duplicates. Exact search phrasing. End every page in flywheel CTA.

Docx First 10 -> live URLs

- 1. Writing Checker landing -> /ielts-essay-checker (title/FAQ/schema)
- 2-3. Band 7 / 6->7 -> UPDATE plateau + band-6-vs-7
- 4. Task 2 structure -> CREATE Wave A; bridge opinion post
- 5. Band score calculator -> /ielts-writing-band-score + scoring post
- 6. Essay types hub -> CREATE Wave B; bridge opinion
- 7-10. TR / CC / Lexical / Grammar -> deepen existing criteria posts

Priority UPDATE slugs (exact titles)

- stuck-at-band-6-5-plateau -> Why Am I Stuck at 6.5 / Improve 6.5 to 7
- band-6-vs-7-task-2 -> Difference Between Band 6 and Band 7
- how-ielts-writing-is-scored -> How Scores Are Calculated
- coherence-cohesion-14-day-plan -> Band 7+ without overusing linking words
- lexical-resource-band-6-to-7 -> Lexical mistakes that drop your score
- Samples edu/tech/env -> full flywheel block (analysis -> try it -> checker)

C6 weekly GSC decision rules

- Impressions>100, pos 4-15: IMPROVE NOW (highest ROI)
- Pos 1-3, low CTR: rewrite title/meta only
- Wrong URL ranking: fix cannibalization
- 0 impressions @14d: re-index; @21d: investigate prerender; @90d: merge/prune
- Query with impressions but no page: insert into next create queue

Part D - Create queues

First-30 mix: 10 commercial/problem + 10 writing-skill + 10 topic/sample.

Ship-first five (exact titles)

- How to Improve IELTS Writing from 6.5 to 7
- How to Improve IELTS Writing from 7 to 8
- Is ChatGPT Accurate for IELTS Writing Score?
- Best Essay Structure for IELTS Writing Task 2
- How Many Words for IELTS Writing Task 2

Wave A - high-intent / fast rank (front-load Q&A)

- Word count / paragraphs / idioms / Can I use I / timing / generate ideas
- ChatGPT accuracy / overestimates / prompts / best AI tools 2026 / practice
- Always score Band 6? / overused words + Band 7 alternatives / Can AI check my essay?

Wave B - criteria + essay types

- TR/TA fix, GRA Top 10, Agree/Disagree, Discuss Both, Adv/Dis, Problem-Solution, Two-part
- Essay-types hub, intro/paraphrase, self-edit, Task 1 overview/mistakes, GT openings
- Task 1 vs Task 2 guide, body/conclusion, AI feedback prompt guide

Wave C - topic Band 9 flywheel

- Format: Question -> Band 9 sample -> examiner analysis (TR/CC/LR/GRA) -> try it -> AI score
- Themes: Education, Technology, Environment, Health, Government, Work
- Each page UNIQUE (no template cloning). Upgrade existing edu/tech/env samples first.

D9 Data moat (start Week 3)

- Monthly study from real grading data (mistakes capping Band 6; ChatGPT vs us vs examiner)
- Free widgets: band score calculator + Task 2 word counter
- Pitch studies for backlinks. Anonymize + state methodology.

Part E - 12-week timeline

- W0-1 Foundation: GSC www, sitemap, indexing, prerender, www align, IndexNow, scorecard
- W1-2: P0 polish + E-E-A-T ship + 5-6 Wave A Q&A + refresh plateau/band-6-vs-7
- W3-4: Wave A finish + tool depth + calculator widget + start accuracy data study
- W5-6: Wave B essay types + publish data study + homepage latest blog links
- W7-8: Wave B finish + Tier-1 refresh + second data study
- W9-10: Topic samples Edu/Tech/Env (unique, full flywheel)
- W11-12: Health/Gov/Work + GSC rewrites + 90d prune + next-quarter queue

Velocity + indexing (every publish, same day)

2-3 new posts/week (SERP Mon, draft Tue-Wed, review+publish Thu-Fri). 2 improves/week from C6. Improves on pages with impressions beat new posts if capacity is tight. Pipeline: regen sitemap -> GSC Request indexing -> IndexNow -> homepage/hub link -> day-7 check. Quality bar always gates publish (HCU risk).

Part F - KPIs + milestones

- Indexed URL count | Time-to-index <7 days (if slips, stop creating)
- Impressions P0+Wave A | CTR on rewritten titles
- Queries in top 10 / top 3 (weekly) | Featured snippets / PAA captured
- Organic landings on /ielts-essay-checker | Free eval starts
- Referring domains (monthly) | Zero-impression @90d prune list
- Monthly: who holds pos 1-3 on the 20 D2 keywords (Liz / Advantage / Writing9)

Honest milestones (newer domain)

- W2-4: Q&A indexed, first impressions
- W4-8: long-tail top-10, first snippets
- W8-12: Wave A top-5 exact match; checker impressions climb
- Months 4-6: cluster authority; commercial head terms move - do not panic-pivot early

Remember

Foundation before content. Improve before near-duplicates. Every post feeds the flywheel. Cadence ops: WEBSITE_SEO_CADENCE.md. Full matrices and queues: WEBSITE_SEO_ROADMAP.md.